to peace. But when London's Lord Ahmed, the only Kashmiri Muslim in Britain's House of Lords, started to speak on behalf of the Kashmiri community about the conduct of Indian troops in Kashmir, who had "raped many Muslim women there," he ignited so volatile a response from Hindu Indians in the room that most of them jumped to their feet, shouting, "Lies! Retract! Throw him out!" Several of my own colleagues screamed, "Boycott this meeting!" and advanced with fists clenched toward the speaker. Our campus police, fearing a riot, asked me to permit them to clear the room. My repeated appeals for nonviolent civility and freedom of speech, however, managed to convince most of our audience to return to their seats a few minutes later; only a handful of angry Pandits stomped out, urging all Indians to boycott the conference.

Somehow we managed to complete our conference without further violent shouting or dire threats, and a few useful suggestions did emerge by the end of that day on potential ways to resolve the bitter Indo-Pakistani conflict over Kashmir. I had hoped that we would draft a road map to peace that Sunday, but I felt grateful, when it had ended, that we had avoided bloodshed. I vividly realized that if a few strong words spoken on our beautiful campus half a world away could trigger so much explosive anger and hatred, what terrifying damage daily gunfire and suicide bombings were doing in the once-happy Valley of Kashmir itself. I did not abandon all hope of helping to resolve that dreadful conflict, but I knew it would take far longer than I had once naïvely anticipated.

So many friends have helped me over the past four decades that I regret being unable to acknowledge my indebtedness to them all. I must first mention my Sanskrit guru, Professor W. Norman Brown, founding chair of the Department of South Asian Studies at the University of Pennsylvania, who awakened my interest in the tragic plight of Kashmir. Professors Holden Furber and Norman Palmer of Penn also shared with me their insights gained from many visits to Kashmir, as did Professor Richard Park of Berkeley and Vice-Chancellor J. Richard Sisson of UCLA. Many diplomat friends have added to my appreciation of how arduous their struggles have been in the pursuit of Indo-Pakistani peace, and I thank each of them for sharing their wisdom with me: Ambassador Robert B. Oakley, Ambassador Frank Wisner, Ambassador Jamsheed Marker, High Commissioner Kuldip Nayar, Ambassador Riaz Khokhar, Ambassador Teresita Schaffer, High Commissioner S.I. Abbas, Ambassador Abid Hussain, and Ambassador Rick Inderfurth.